A short tour of Folio. Use this document to try every feature.

Getting around

Scroll to read continuously, or use the page box at the bottom of the window to jump to a page. The sidebar on the left shows page thumbnails; switch to **Outline** to see this document's bookmarks, one for each section.

On a Mac, use ⌘ wherever this guide says Ctrl.

Zoom with Ctrl + + and Ctrl + −, or hold Ctrl and use the mouse wheel. Choose **Fit width** or **Fit page** from the zoom menu. Press 2 for a two-page spread and R to rotate.

Opening documents

Drag a PDF file anywhere into the window, press Ctrl + O, or open PDFs straight from your file manager (File Explorer, Finder, and so on). You can also drop or paste a link, or press Ctrl + Shift + O to enter one. PDF links open directly, and webpages are turned into a PDF you can highlight and mark up.

Folio remembers recent documents on this computer, including the page you were reading, so you can pick up where you left off.

> Your documents stay on your device. Folio doesn't upload files or collect usage data.

Finding text

Press Ctrl + F and type a word to search. Try searching for **lighthouse**: it appears several times in the passage below. Every match is highlighted, and the results list shows each matching page with a snippet.

A short passage to search

The lighthouse stood at the end of a long stone pier, its lamp turning slowly through the evening fog. Ships far out at sea watched for its beam, counting the seconds between flashes to know which coast they were passing. The keeper climbed the spiral stairs each night, trimmed the wick, and polished the great lens until it shone.

In time, the lighthouse was automated, and the keeper's cottage became a small museum. Visitors still climb the stairs to look out across the water, and on clear nights the lighthouse continues its patient work, one flash every ten seconds, as it has for more than a century.

Highlights and notes

Select any text and click a color to highlight it, or press H. To add a note, type it in the box under the colors and press Enter (N jumps to the box). Click any highlight to change its color, edit its note, or remove it. Try it on a sentence in the passage above.

Every highlight and note appears in the **Notes** tab of the sidebar, with a box for notes about the whole document. They're saved automatically and come back whenever you reopen the file. Ctrl + S saves a PDF copy that includes them.

You can also **Draw** freehand (D) or add a **Text** box (T) from the toolbar.

Asking AI

Open **Ask AI** (the sparkle button) to ask questions about the whole document, or select a passage and choose **Ask AI** to ask about just that part. Answers cite page numbers you can click. Connect your ChatGPT plan with **Continue with ChatGPT**, or use your Claude subscription through Claude Code.

Signing

Choose **Sign** to add a handwritten signature. Capture one with your camera or upload a photo of your signature on white paper; Folio removes the paper background. Folio suggests signature lines it finds, but nothing is placed until you approve it.

Signature

Signatures are added as images. They aren't cryptographic digital signatures.

Reading comfortably

The ⋯ menu at the top right switches between the light and dark interface and turns on **Night reading**, which dims bright pages for reading in the dark while keeping photos and figures in their true colors. Folio remembers your choice. Press F for focus mode, which hides everything but the page; Esc exits.

Keyboard shortcuts

ACTION	SHORTCUT
Open a file	Ctrl O
Open from URL	Ctrl Shift O
Highlight selection / write a note	H / N
Find	Ctrl F

Save a copy	Ctrl S
Print	Ctrl P
Toggle sidebar	Ctrl \
Focus mode	F
All shortcuts	?

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